

BKM 10 Enrichment

E1. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin: “As with all gifts, [the gift of the Holy Ghost] must be received and accepted to be enjoyed. When priesthood hands were laid upon your head to confirm you a member of the Church, you heard the words, ‘Receive the Holy Ghost.’ This did not mean that the Holy Ghost unconditionally became your constant companion. Scriptures warn us that the Spirit of the Lord will ‘not always strive with man.’ When we are confirmed, we are given the right to the companionship of the Holy Ghost, but it is a right that we must continue to earn through obedience and worthiness. We cannot take this gift for granted” (“[The Unspeakable Gift](#),” *Ensign*, May 2003, 27).

E2. Elder Bruce R. McConkie: “Priesthood and priestcraft are two opposites; one is of God, the other of the devil. When ministers claim but do not possess the priesthood; when they set themselves up as lights to their congregations, but do not preach the pure and full gospel; when their interest is in gaining personal popularity and financial gain, rather than in caring for the poor and ministering to the wants and needs of their fellow men—they are engaged, in a greater or lesser degree, in the practice of priestcrafts.” (*Mormon Doctrine*, p593)

E3. Elder Ezra Taft Benson: “Not only are there apostates within our midst, but there are also apostate doctrines that are sometimes taught in our classes and from our pulpits and that appear in our publications. And these apostate precepts of men cause our people to stumble...

“Christ taught that we should be in the world but not of it. Yet there are some in our midst who are not so much concerned about taking the gospel to the world as they are about bringing worldliness into the gospel. They want us to be popular with the worldly even though a prophet has said that it is impossible, for all hell would then want to join us.

“Through their own reasoning and a few misapplied scriptures, they try to sell us the precepts and philosophies of men. They do not feel the Church is progressive enough.” (CR, Apr 1969)

E4. President George Q. Cannon: “If the breach is daily widening between ourselves and the world ... we may be assured that our progress is certain, however slow. On the opposite hand, if our feeling and affections, our appetites and desires, are in unison with the world around us and we freely fraternize with them ... we should do well to examine ourselves.” (*Millennial Star* 23 [5 October]: 645-46. Cited by Ezra Taft Benson, C.R., Oct. 1969, p. 15)

2 Nephi 26:11 “For the Spirit of the Lord will not always strive with man. And when the Spirit ceaseth to strive with man then cometh speedy destruction, and this grieveth my soul.”

E5. President Boyd K. Packer: “The world is spiraling downward at an ever-quickening pace. I am sorry to tell you that it will not get better.”

“I know of nothing in the history of the Church or in the history of the world to compare with our present circumstances. Nothing happened in Sodom and Gomorrah which exceeds in wickedness and depravity that surrounds us now ... At Sodom and Gomorrah these things were localized. Now they are spread across the world, and they are among us.” (“The One Pure Defense,” Address to CES Religious Educators, 6 February 2004, Salt Lake Tabernacle (2004 by Intellectual Reserve, Inc.), p. 4.)

E6. President John Taylor: “You can know the difference between the Spirit of the Lord and the spirit of the adversary, when you find that you are happy and contented, that you love your fellows, that you are anxious for their welfare; and you can tell that you do not have that Spirit when you are full of animosity and feel that you would like to bring somebody down.” (*Teachings of the Presidents of the Church*, Heber J. Grant, 152)

2 Nephi 26:22 “... he leadeth them by the neck with a flaxen cord, until he bindeth them with his strong cords forever.”

E7. Ted L. Gibbons: “I tried to buy some flax thread one day here in Orem. The lady at the counter told me it was nearly hopeless. She said something like this:

‘Flaxen thread is so fragile that it is almost useless, unless one is willing to work very carefully by hand. A sewing machine will not function with so fragile a thread.’

“And yet Satan leads the Gentiles about with a ‘flaxen cord.’ He is ever so careful and so subtle. We may know when the first loops of flax encircle our necks, but we feel no fear. It is only flax, and we can break it any time we want to. And so the number of strands of flax increases, imperceptibly and slowly. We hardly notice that the movies and TV shows we see this year are more degraded than those we watched last year. We become less and less shocked by obscenity or vulgarity; common stands of modesty and decency seem less critical than they did to our ancestors.

(1. Ted L. Gibbons, at LDSGospelDoctrine.net, Select 2016 BofM. Select 10) 2 Nephi 6-10. Select Ted L. Gibbons GD lesson material from LDSLiving.

E8. Elder Carlos Asay:

Bound with Flaxen Thread

"I have invited two young men, Elder Brockman and Elder Robey, to help me introduce my subject. Will you two please step forward. You will note that both have their wrists bound together. Though you may not be able to see the material that I have used in binding my friends, it is the same for each—flaxen thread.

"Elder Robey's wrists are tied with only one strand of the flaxen material. I will now invite him to muster all his strength and courage and break free. (Pause) Did you notice how easy and effortless that was?

"Elder Brockman's wrists are tied with twenty strands of the flaxen thread. I now ask him to do what Elder Robey did. (Pause) If you were close to the pulpit, you would see that my captive is really trying to break his cords. You would also observe that, as he strains to break the thread, it is beginning to make indentations in his wrists, and, if he were to continue much further, I think it would cut and draw blood. Thank you very much.

Bound by Habits

"I have engaged you in this simple demonstration to make a point. Suppose each strand of thread used in binding these young men represented one bad habit. From the demonstration, we might conclude that a single bad habit has limited restricting power. A number of bad habits, however, has great power—almost limitless power.

" 'The chains of habit,' said one man, 'are too small to be felt until they are too strong to be broken' (Samuel Johnson)." ("Flaxen Threads," BYU Speeches, Feb 07, 1982.)

2 Nephi 26:25 "Behold, doth he cry unto any, saying: Depart from me? Behold I say unto you, Nay; but he saith: Come unto me all ye ends of the earth, buy milk and honey, without money and without price."

E9. Elder Marion G. Romney: "When earth life is over and things appear in their true perspective, we shall more clearly see and realize what the Lord and his prophets have repeatedly told us, that the fruits of the gospel are the only objectives worthy of life's full efforts. Their possessor obtains true wealth—wealth in the Lord's view of values..."

"I conceive the blessings of the gospel to be of such inestimable worth that the price for them must be very exacting, and if I correctly understand what the Lord has said on the subject, it is. The price, however, is within the reach of us all, because it is not to be paid in money nor in any of this world's goods but in righteous living. What is required is whole hearted devotion to the gospel and unreserved allegiance to the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints... A half-hearted performance is not enough." (*Conference Report*, Oct. 1949, p.39 as recorded in the O.T. Institute Manual, p. 203)

2 Nephi 29:3 "And because my words shall hiss forth—many of the Gentiles shall say: A Bible! A Bible! We have got a Bible, and there cannot be any more Bible."

E10. McConkie and Millet: "The fundamental error of Bible cultists is the doctrine of Bible infallibility. This tenet holds that the Bible must be 'completely authoritative and trustworthy in all that it asserts as factual, whether in matters of theology, history, or science.' The Bible, it is held, 'does not contain error of any kind.'

"It has to be significant that the Bible makes no such claim for itself: There is not a single passage of scripture that can properly be used to sustain such a view. For is there any agreement among those maintaining such a position as to what version of the Bible should be used or what the Bible is saying on a host of matters.

"... To claim for the Bible what it does not claim for itself is to misuse the Bible. The Bible does not claim to be the constitution of the church, it does not claim to be infallible, nor does it claim to be the answer in all things. What the Bible does claim is that whenever God had a people that he acknowledged as his own he spoke to them through living prophets who then added those words to the canon of scripture. The purpose and spirit of the Bible is to open the heavens, not to seal them." (McConkie and Millet, *Sustaining and Defending the Faith*, pp. 40, 50)

2 Nephi 29:6-7 "Thou fool, that shall say: A Bible, we have got a Bible, and we need no more Bible. Have ye obtained a Bible save it were by the Jews?"

"Know ye not that there are more nations than one? Know ye not that I, the Lord your God, have created all men, and that I remember those who are upon the isles of the sea; and that I rule in the heavens above and in the earth beneath; and I bring forth my word unto the children of men, yea, even upon all the nations of the earth?"

E11. Elder B.H. Roberts: "While the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints is established for the instruction of men; and is one of God's instrumentalities for making known the truth, yet he is not limited to that institution for such purposes, neither in time nor place. God raises up wise men ... of their own tongue and nationality, speaking to them through means that they can comprehend; not always giving a fulness of truth such as may be found in the fulness of the gospel of Jesus Christ; but always giving that measure of truth that the people are prepared to receive. 'Mormonism holds, then, that all the great teachers [those who teach principles of truth and virtue] are servants of God; among all nations and in all ages. They are inspired men, appointed to instruct God's children according to the conditions in the midst of which he finds them... Wherever God finds a soul sufficiently enlightened and pure; one with whom his Spirit can communicate, lo! He makes of him a teacher of men. While the path of

sensuality and darkness may be that which most men tread, a few ... have been led along the upward path; a few in all countries and generations have been wisdom seekers, or seekers of God. They have been so because the Divine Word of Wisdom has looked upon them, choosing them for the knowledge and service of himself.” (*Defense of the Faith and the Saints* 1:512-13 from *Joseph Smith, the Choice Seer*, McConkie and Millet, chapter 2. See also *Improvement Era, Volume 8, Issue 1*.)

2 Nephi 30:12 “And then shall the wolf dwell with the lamb; and the leopard shall lie down with the kid, and the calf, and the young lion, and the fatling, together; and a little child shall lead them.”

E12. Joseph Smith: “In pitching my tent we found three massasaguas, or prairie rattlesnakes, which the brethren were about to kill, but I said, ‘Let them alone—don’t hurt them! How will the serpent ever lose his venom, while the servants of God possess the same disposition, and continue to make war upon it? Men must become harmless, before the brute creation; and when men lose their vicious dispositions and cease to destroy the animal race, the lion and the lamb can dwell together, and the suckling child can play with the serpent in safety.’ The brethren took the serpents carefully on sticks and carried them across the creek. I exhorted the brethren not to kill a serpent, bird or an animal of any kind during my journey unless it became necessary in order to preserve ourselves from hunger.” (*History of the Church*, vol. 2, pp. 71-2)

2 Nephi 30:17 “There is nothing which is secret save it shall be revealed; there is no work of darkness save it shall be manifest in the light ...”

E13. President John Taylor: “Man sleeps the sleep of death, but the spirit lives where the record of his deeds is kept. Man sleeps for a time in the grave, and by and by he rises again from the dead and goes to judgment; and then the secret thoughts of all men are revealed before him with whom we have to do; we cannot hide them; it would be in vain then for a man to say, ‘I did not do so and so’; the command would be, unravel and read the record which he has made of himself and let it testify in relation to these things, and all could gaze upon it.” (*Miracle of Forgiveness*, p. 108-9)

E#. Additional Teaching Ideas (from Lesson #1)

2. Sharing the Book of Mormon

“Consult with the bishopric and the ward mission leader about how members can obtain copies of the Book of Mormon to share with nonmember friends and acquaintances.

“In class, suggest that a class goal this year should be to share the Book of Mormon with nonmember friends and acquaintances. Explain to class members

how they may obtain copies of the Book of Mormon, and encourage each class member to give a copy to at least one friend or acquaintance during the year.

“Several times during the year, as the Spirit directs, ask class members if any of them have yet shared a copy of the Book of Mormon. Invite class members who have done this to briefly describe the experience. Continue to encourage class members to share the Book of Mormon with others.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Recommended Reading and Viewing Resources:

Ensign Articles about the Book of Mormon:

1. President Ezra Taft Benson, “[The Book of Mormon—Keystone of our Religion](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986.
2. Boyd K. Packer, “[The Book of Mormon: Another Testament of Jesus Christ—Plain and Precious Things](#),” *Ensign*, May 2005, 6-9.
3. President Marion G. Romney, “[The Book of Mormon](#),” *Ensign*, May 1980, 67).
4. James A. Cullimore (Assistant to the Twelve), “[The Book of Mormon](#),” *Ensign*, May 1976.

Ensign Articles or BYU Speeches:

1. Elder Charles Didier, “[Testimony](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1991, 63.
2. Carlos E. Asay, “[Flaxen Threads](#),” BYU Speeches, Feb 07, 1982.

Scholarly Resources of Interest:

1. [Book of Mormon Central.org](#).
 2. [2016 Gospel Doctrine—Recommended Resources on the Book of Mormon \(updated\)](#), Ben S., Times and Seasons, December 19, 2015.
 3. “[Complexity, Consistency, Ignorance, and Probabilities](#),” Melvin J. Thorne, *Book of Mormon Authorship: Revisited*, Chapter 7.
 4. BYU Studies Quarterly, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **10** 2 Nephi 6-10.. Select BYU Studies GD lesson material. Click on “Menu”. Scroll down to click on “Book of Mormon Lessons”. Scroll down to click on 10. “He Inviteth All to Come unto Him”.
 5. “[The Plain and Precious Parts](#),” John Welch, Chapter 10 in *Reexploring the Book of Mormon*, pp. 37-40.
- Chiasmus:**
John W. Welch, “[A Book You Can Respect](#),” *Ensign*, Sept. 1977, 45-58.

Blogs of Interest:

1. Ted L. Gibbons, at [LDSLiving.com](#). Select “**Lesson Helps**.” Scroll down and, if necessary, click page 2. Select “[Book of Mormon Lesson 10](#)”.
2. Nancy Jensen, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **10** 2 Nephi 6-10. Select Nancy Jensen Gospel Doctrine lesson material blog “LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus”.

3. Gerald Smith, at LDSGospelDoctrine.net), Select 2016 BofM. Select 10) 2 Nephi 6-10. Select Gerald Smith Gospel Doctrine lesson blog “Joel’s Monastery”.

4. Lenet H. Read, at LDSGospelDoctrine.net), Select 2016 BofM. Select 10) 2 Nephi 6-10. Select Lenet Read GD lessons.

Non-Mormon Views of Mormons or the Gospel:

1. Stephen H. Webb, “[Mormonism obsessed with Christ](#),” First Things, accessed 1/16/16.

When you read this article by a former evangelical Christian who converted to Catholicism, Ponderize the BKM 3 Quotes: ¶1 and ¶2 with it. Stephen H. Webb is professor of religion and philosophy at Wabash College.

2. Joel J. Miller, “[The dangers of DIY spirituality](#),” *Theology That Sticks*, February 22, 2016. [NOTE: Joel is not a Mormon, but as I read his article, I thought of Christ: of His Atonement; of His words, and of His Church here on earth. We should not try to do-it-ourselves.]

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